Boston Sunday Globe

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Affluence, with a side of effluence

Leafy Carlisle's septic problems bubbling over

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

There is an uncanny quality to the village center of Carlisle.

To walk past the grassy common, beneath the two white church steeples on the hill, is to engage in a kind of time travel. What you see is what Henry David Thoreau saw when he arrived from Concord nearly 180 years ago and gave the place its nickname: the City in the Woods.

What you don't see is the sewage seeping through the earth, or the E. coli infiltrating the town's wells, or the growing piles of dirt in residents' backyards that they hope will filter their homes' refuse before it leaches into the ground water.

Carlisle is currently facing a potential "doomsday scenario," to use one resident's phrase, that could eventually render the picturesque village center uninhabitable. Septic systems are failing. Wells are set too close to leaching fields. The drinking water — at Town Hall, the library, and the school — keeps setting off

CARLISLE, Page A16



The ICA has traced a journey through art over 90 years, including (above) an exhibit by Andy Warhol in the late 1960s. **Art+Life, N1.**

Kitchens and baths maybe be necessities, but we have some ideas on how to make them stand out. **Globe Magazine.**

The Patriots' place in the AFC is about what we thought it would be, writes Dan Shaughnessy. **Sports, D1.**

Fall for you

Sunday: Sunny, nice.
High: 61-66. Low: 43-48.

Monday: Sunny, some clouds.
High: 68-73. Low: 45-50.

High tide: 10:56 a.m. 11:25 p.m.

Sunrise: 7:09 Sunset: 5:47

Complete report, **B10.**

Deaths, **A17-21.**

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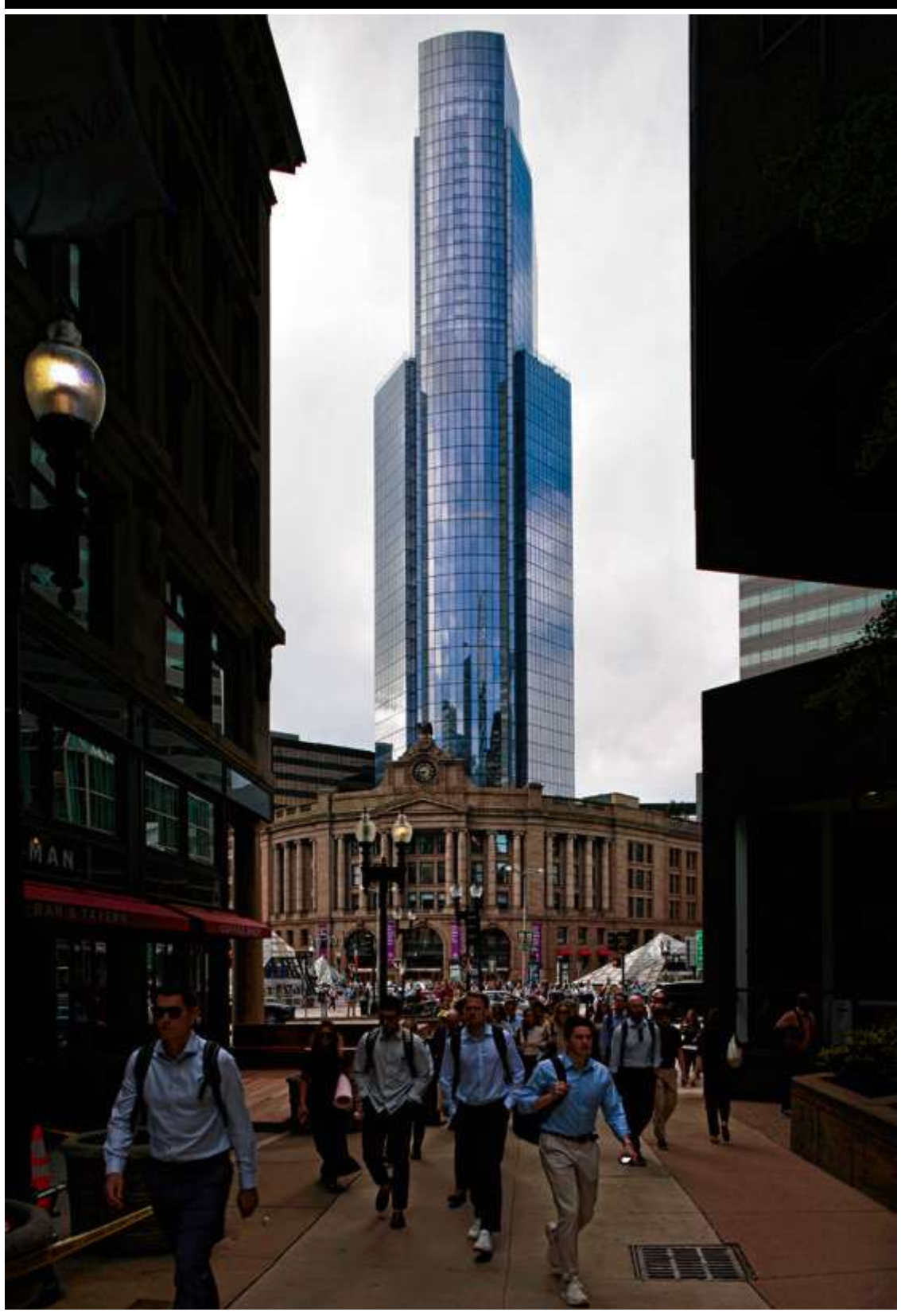
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WHY MASS. LOST ITS MOJO — AND HOW WE GET IT BACK

Peak Boston?



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

South Station Tower rose above commuters near Dewey Square.

A Rorschach test for the state of building in the city, the South Station high-rise could be the last new skyscraper here for a long time

BY CATHERINE CARLOCK
GLOBE STAFF

Seventh in a series examining the challenges facing the Massachusetts economy.

South Station Tower is something of a miracle.

It's also a reminder that even miracles are of their time.

Investors spent much of the past decade pouring cash into Boston commercial real estate, a bet many saw as among the safest in the world. Developers used that money to fuel a building boom; half of the city's 10 tallest towers have been built since 2015.

Millennium Tower and Winthrop Center in the Financial District. One Dalton in Back Bay. One Congress near North Station.

The last one to be finished, soaring more than two football fields high atop the city's busiest train station, is South Station Tower. The $1.5 billion structure is a herculean feat of engineering and logistics, in which an army of construction workers fashioned 51 stories of steel, glass, and concrete in the air above train tracks, subways, buses, and passengers.

SOUTH STATION TOWER, Page A14

Party unity at risk in Mich. race

Tensions linger over 2024 between Black, Arab American voters

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

DEARBORN, Mich. — Since starting the Arab American News in 1984, publisher Osama Siblani has witnessed dramatic advances by his community in this Detroit suburb and across this pivotal battleground state.

Once relegated to Dearborn's south end, Arab Americans are now the majority of its 106,000 residents — the first and largest US city with that distinction. Politicians such as Dearborn Mayor Abdullah Hammoud and US Representative Rashida Tlaib, both Democrats, have risen to top electoral offices. And on Nov. 3, Democratic Senate candidate Abdul El-Sayed could make the biggest leap yet.

"The possibilities are there right now for an Arab American and a Muslim American to be a US senator," Siblani said as he sat on a sofa in the publication's Dearborn offices, likening the impact to John F. Kennedy becoming the first Catholic president. "We crossed that bridge. Now we have a bridge also that we have to cross."

But for El-Sayed to become the nation's first Muslim US senator, he'll have to overcome the aftermath of a volatile presidential election in Michigan two years ago that inflamed longstanding tensions between Arab American and Black voters.

Former president Joe Biden's support for Israel's war in Gaza triggered outrage from Arab American Democrats that helped President Trump narrowly win the state in 2024.

MICHIGAN, Page A12

Trying to play through latest Trump fixation

D.C. course in his sights, and golfers aren't happy

By Dan McGowan
GLOBE COLUMNIST

WASHINGTON — On a leisurely walk down the 200-yard, par-3 eighth hole on the Blue Course at East Potomac Golf Links, the serenity of this stretch of public parkland in the nation's capital collides with the simmering tension over its future.

To the right, beyond the Japanese cherry trees lining the park's perimeter, cyclists and runners move along the waterfront, with the Washington Channel shining in the afternoon sun. To the left, across a different fairway, orange traffic cones mark off a broad swath of cleared land, where construction vehicles sit among the stumps and felled trees. The Washington Monument stands unmistakably in the distance, an enduring presence in a city roiled by uncertainty.

On a sunny, 70-degree Thursday in October, the strokes pile up for a retired pilot, a political consultant, and a recent college graduate who had never met before being paired with a Globe reporter. They laugh at their errant shots, reminding themselves that even a rough day on the golf course beats a day at work.

President Trump has derided East Potomac as "Trash Island" and proposed transforming

GOLF COURSE, Page A13

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